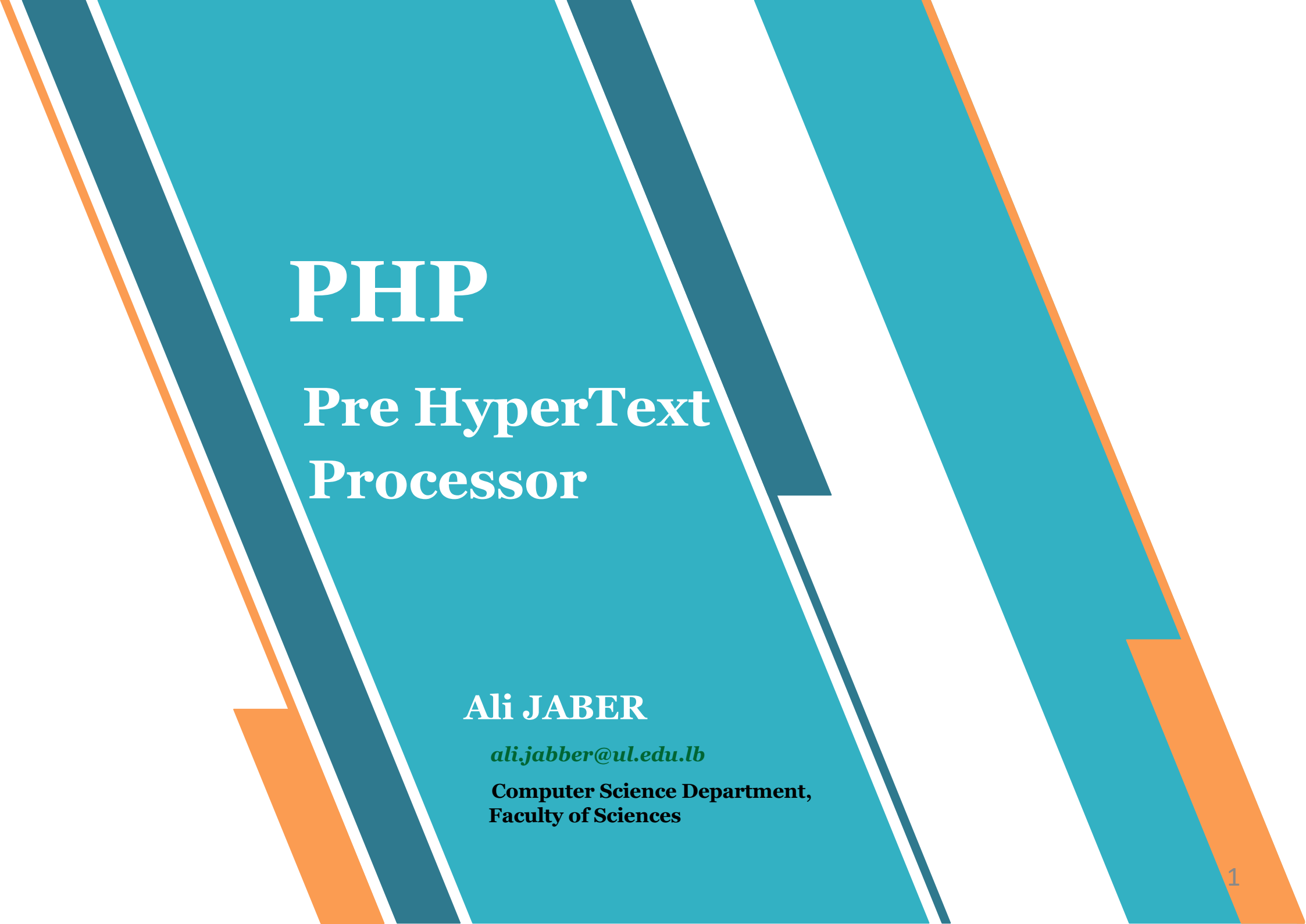




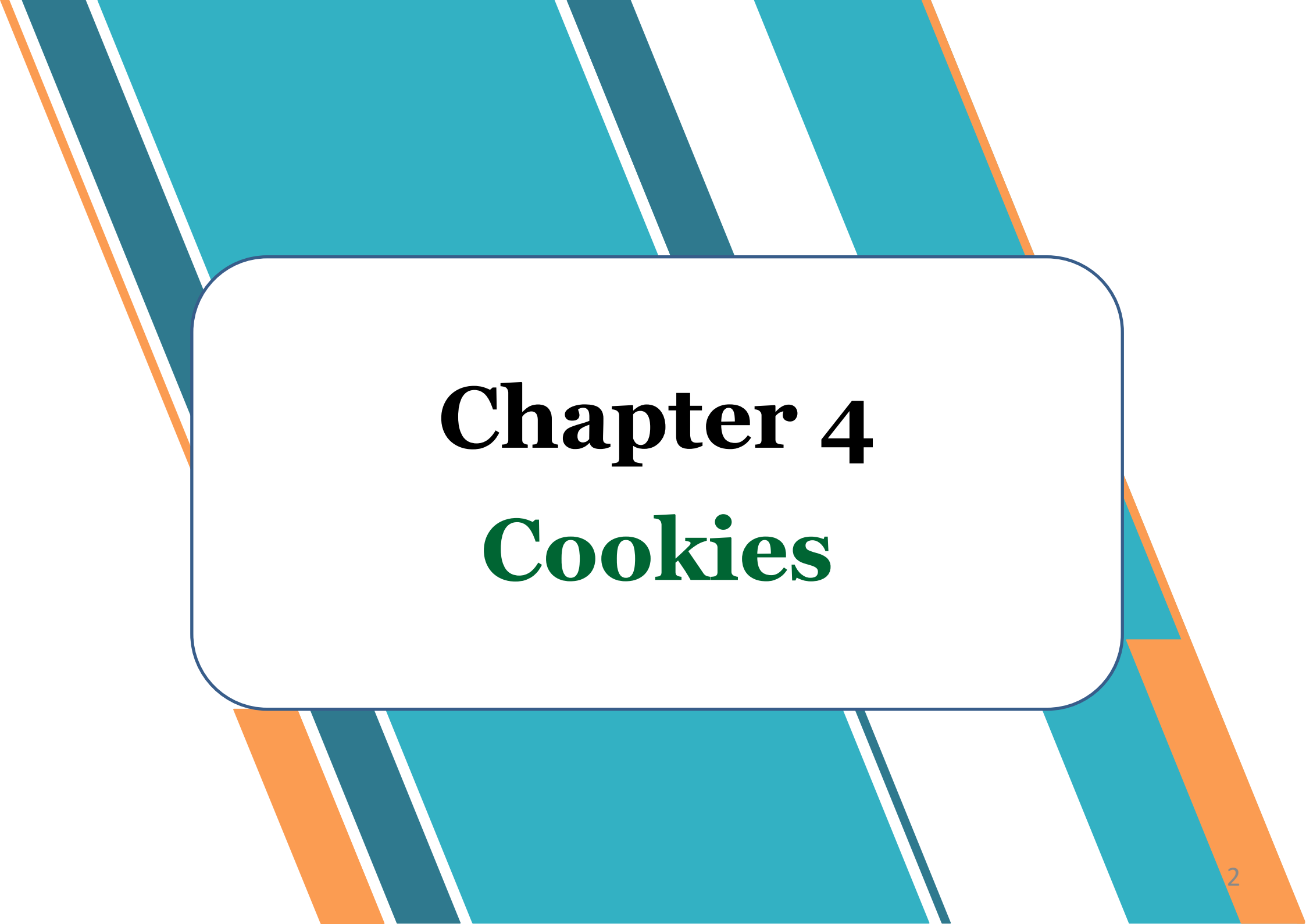
PHP

Pre HyperText Processor

Ali JABER

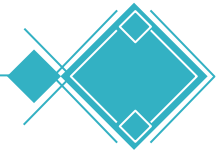
ali.jabber@ul.edu.lb

**Computer Science Department,
Faculty of Sciences**



Chapter 4

Cookies



Definition and Example



■ What is a Cookie?

A cookie is often used to identify a user. A cookie is a small file that the server embeds on the user's computer. Each time the same computer requests a page with a browser, it will send the cookie too. With PHP, you can both create and retrieve cookie values.

A cookie is a small file that is saved on the visitor's computer. This file contains text and is used to “remember” information about the visitor. For example, you enter the visitor's nickname (Login, Password, etc.) in a cookie, so the next time they come to your site you can read their nickname by looking at what their cookie contains.

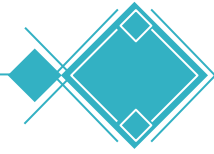
■ Create Cookies With PHP

A cookie is created with the `setcookie()` function.

Syntax: **setcookie** (name, value, expire, path, domain, secure, httponly);

Only the name parameter is required. All other parameters are optional.

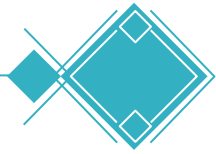




Important Notes



- You must call **setcookie()** before any <HTML> or <HEAD> tag because cookies must pass before other in headers.
- The cookie will only be accessible before loading the next page, or reloading of the current page:
 - when the browser calls a page via HTTP, it looks for valid cookies for that page and if so, sends them to the HTTP request header.

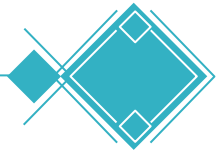


Definition and Example



```
<?php
    $cookie_name = "user";
    $cookie_value= "Ali Jaber";
    setcookie($cookie_name, $cookie_value, time() + (86400 * 30), "/");
    // 86400 = 60*60*24 = 1 day
?>
<html>
    <head><title>session cookie</title></head>
<body>
<?php
    if(!isset($_COOKIE[$cookie_name])) {
        echo "Cookie named " . $cookie_name . " is not set!";
    }
    else {
        echo "Cookie " . $cookie_name . " is set!<br>";
        echo "Value is: " . $_COOKIE[$cookie_name];
    }
?>
</body>
</html>
```



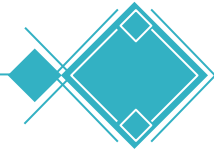


Definition and Example



- **Cookie** = small information stored in the browser of the client machine.

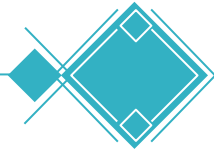
```
<?php
    if (isset ($_COOKIE['counter']))
        setcookie("counter", $_COOKIE['counter']+1);
        // be careful the first time counter is not defined!
    else
        setcookie("counter",1);
?>
<html>
<head><title>session cookie</title></head>
<body>
<p>
    the page was executed visited <?php echo $_COOKIE['counter'];?> times.
</p>
</body>
</html>
```



Explanations



- **setcookie** defines a cookie that will be sent with the rest of the HTTP communication headers
- The previous script shows the number of times a page has been visited since we started a browser session!
- At each execution, the counter is incremented by 1.
- If we stop the browser and restart it, a new session restarts.
- **\$ _COOKIE** is a superglobal variable (here, an array), which contains the cookies transmitted during the HTTP request.
- **\$ _COOKIE['cookie_name']** returns the value of cookie_name (in the example 'counter').
- **Warning!** the first time, during the setcookie, **\$ _COOKIE** is not assigned the cookie sent to the customer!

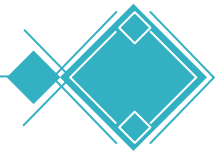


setcookie

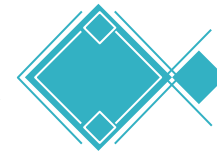


setcookie (name, value, expiration_date, path, domain, secure, httponly)

- **"name"** is the only mandatory argument
- **"expiration_date"**: expiration date of cookie (in seconds)
 - a past date allows to delete a cookie
 - without, the cookie is destroyed when the browser is closed: it is a session cookie.
- **"path"** = path on the server where the cookie will be available.
 - If the value is '/', it will be available on the entire domain **"domain"**
 - If the value is '/rep/', it will only be available in the /rep/ directory as well as subdirectories like '/rep/rep1/' for example. domain **"domain"** .
 - The default value is the current directory where the cookie has been defined.
- **"domain"** = domain where the cookie is available
 - ".u-picardie.fr" indicates that all pages of the sub-domains of u-picardie.fr can read the cookie
 - without, it is the current domain
- **'secure'** : a boolean value (0 or 1) indicating whether access to the cookie is protected, therefore only communicated by HTTPS.
- **"httponly"** : If set to true, the cookie is only available over the HTTP protocol. Scripting languages like JavaScript will not be able to access the cookie.

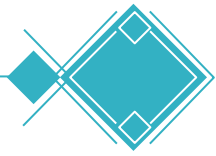


Cookie with Expiry Date

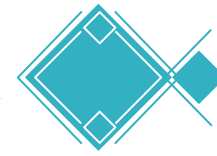


```
<?php
    $expiry=2;
    if ( isset ($_POST['submit']) ) setcookie("counter2",0,time()-3600);
    else if ( isset ($_COOKIE['times']) )
        setcookie("times",$_COOKIE['times']+1, time()+60*60*24*$expiry);
    else setcookie("times",1, time()+60*60*24*$expiry);
?>

<html> <head> <title> cookie: expiration </title> </head>
<body>
<?php
    if ( isset ($_POST['submit']) ) echo "expiration of cookie !";
    else echo 'the page was executed visited'
        .(isset($_COOKIE['times'])? $_COOKIE['times']:0).' fois.<br>'
        .'<form method="post" action="cookie2.php">'
        .'<input type="submit" name="submit" value="Expiry"> </form>' ;
?>
</body></html>
```



Cookie with Expiry Date



The page has been visited 0 times.

expiry

The page has been visited 1 times.

expiry

The page has been visited 2 times.

expiry

Expiration date of the cookie:

- `time()+60*60*24*$expiry` at the current date plus 2 days.
- `time()-3600` allows to "expiry" the cookie.
- the cookie is only accessible when loading the next page, a test avoids the error message!

Close all the browser windows to stop it and restart the browser with **cookie2.php**:
a new session restarts

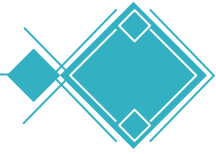
The page has been visited 3 times.

expiry

We click on

expiry

expiration of cookie!

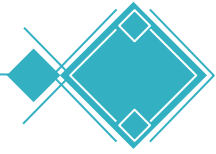


Delete a Cookie



Delete a cookie: To delete a cookie, use the `setcookie()` function with an expiration date in the past

```
<?php
// set the expiration date to one hour ago
setcookie("user", "", time() - 3600);
?>
<html>
<body>
<?php
    echo "Cookie 'user' is deleted.";
?>
</body>
</html>
```



Modify a Cookie



To **modify a cookie**, simply set (again) the cookie using the `setcookie()` function:

```
<?php
if ( isset ($_COOKIE ["User"]) && ($_COOKIE ["User"] == "Ali"))
{
    // change the value of $_COOKIE["User"]
    setcookie("User", "Jaber",time()+3600*30); // valid for one month
}
?>
```



Check if Cookies are Enabled



The following example creates a small script that checks if cookies are enabled. First, try creating a test cookie with the `setcookie()` function, then count the `$_COOKIE` array variable:

```
<?php
    setcookie("test_cookie", "test", time() + 3600, '/');
?>
<html>
<body>
<?php
    if(count($_COOKIE) > 0) {
        echo "Cookies are enabled.";
    } else {
        echo "Cookies are disabled.";
    }
?>
</body>
</html>
```



Cookie: Example



```
<?php
$val = "w3resource tutorials";
setcookie("w3resource", $val, time()+3600, "/home/your_name/", "example.com", 1, 1);
if (isset($_COOKIE['cookie'])) echo $_COOKIE["w3resource"];
?>
```

So what does the code above do?

1. The first parameter sets the cookie name as "w3resource"
2. The second parameter sets the value as "w3resource tutorials"
3. The third parameter indicates that the cookie will expire after 3600 seconds
4. The fourth parameter sets the path to the server /home /your_name where your_name can be a username
5. The fifth parameter sets the (sub)domain that the cookie is available to.
6. The sixth and seventh parameters are set to 1, i.e. true, so the cookie is only available over secure connections and it is only available over HTTP.



Example: all cookies



If you want to recover all cookies, you can use the following command

```
<?php  
  print_r($_COOKIE);  
?>
```